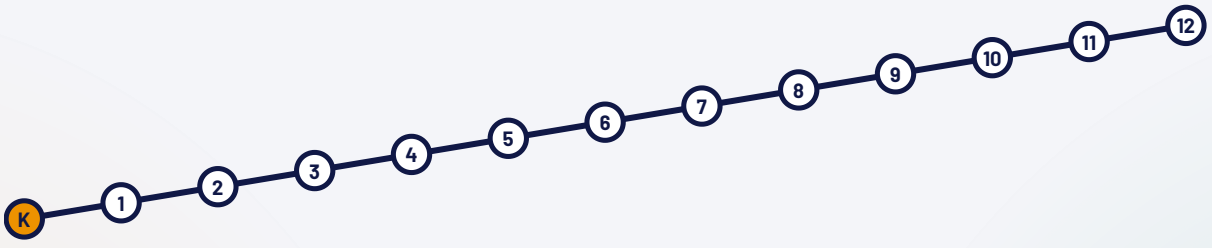
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

Our Curriculum Journey: ELA

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, K-12, and where we could go next.



From the ratings you entered as teachers (2,709 ratings, November 2026): what was reported as taught, not what students know.

Contents

1	**ELA, K-12** English Language Arts from Kindergarten to Grade 12.	3
2	**About the data (at the back)** Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, the limits.	9

Each part: the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each. Items link to the Vertical Alignment site. About the data is at the back. 11 pages, A4.

Taught in depth Introduced / exposed Not taught

ELA, KINDERGARTEN TO GRADE 12

ELA, K-12

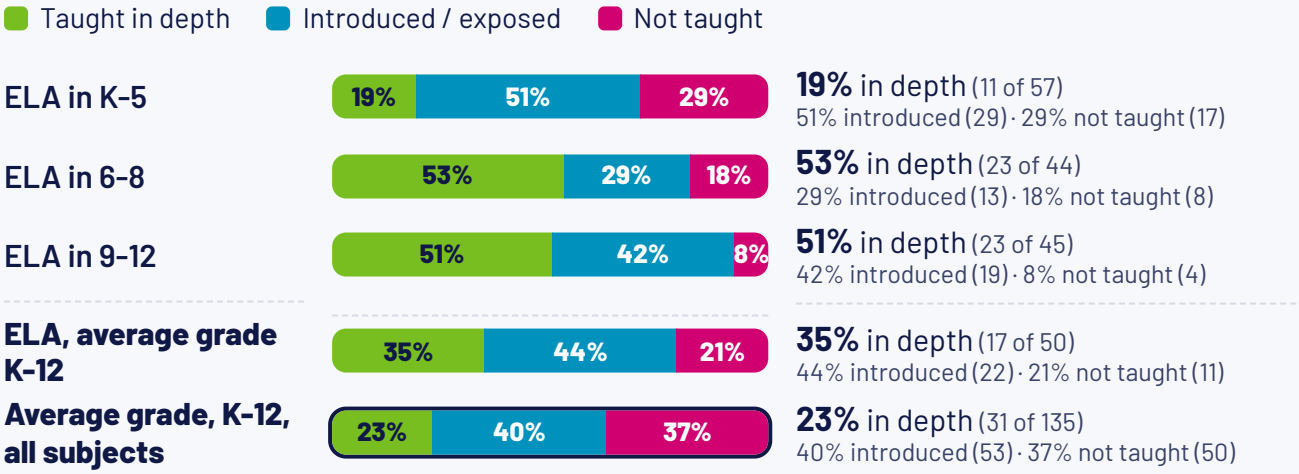
Across K-12, teachers reported that 79% of the 652 ELA ratings (562 standards) are at least introduced, the widest coverage of any subject, and 35% are taught in depth. ELA accounts for more than half of all the in-depth ratings in the school (227 of 406).

THE PICTURE

At a glance: our curricular capacity

What you are seeing. An average grade in a year, by subject: green in depth, blue introduced, pink not taught, with the number of standards.

What it adds to our story. ELA has the widest coverage and the most in-depth ratings of any subject.



Curricular capacity: what an average grade reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. From 652 grade-level ratings, Essential Elements apart. Not a target.

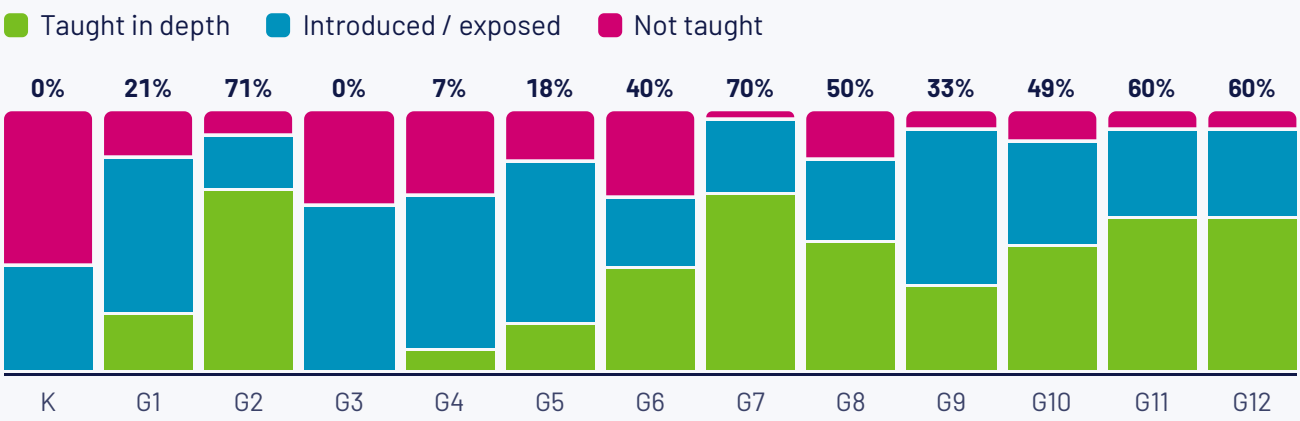
Open the coverage map on the site ↗

THE PICTURE

Grade by grade

What you are seeing. One column per grade. The top number is the share taught in depth.

What it adds to our story. ELA grows strongly from K-5 into secondary, with a few grades that rated little in depth.



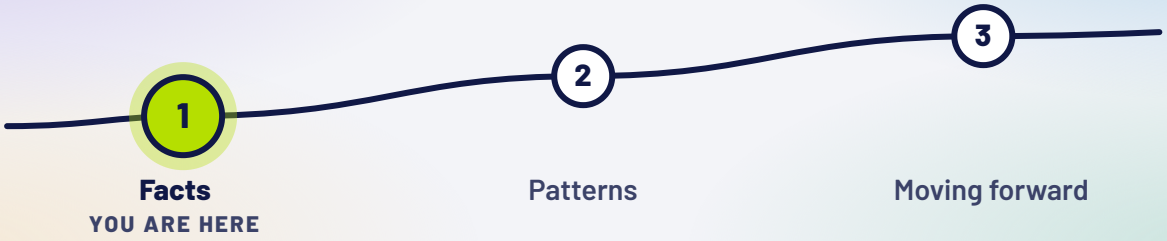
	Elementary						Middle				High		
Strand	K	G1	G2	G3	G4	G5	G6	G7	G8	G9	G10	G11	G12
Language	0%	0%	31%	0%	0%	29%	33%	62%	43%	54%	15%	27%	27%
Reading	0%	33%	78%	0%	22%	11%	33%	89%	33%	22%	67%	78%	78%
Reading Foundational Skills	0%	38%	80%	0%	0%	0%							
Speaking and Listening	0%	38%	88%	0%	13%	13%	50%	63%	63%	38%	38%	100%	100%
Writing	0%	8%	100%	0%	8%	15%	46%	69%	62%	15%	77%	60%	60%

How to read this: each square is the share of that strand's rated standards taught in depth in that grade. Darker green means more in depth. A blank square means the grade has no standards in that strand.

Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗

ELA · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

Section 1: Facts



SECTION 1 OF 3

Facts

What you are seeing. The five main facts. Each links to its data on the site.

What it adds to our story. Reading, writing and talk are strengths. Language (grammar and vocabulary) is the thread to strengthen, and much of it may be taught in other subjects.

1. BRIGHT SPOTS **Grade 2 and Grade 7 are our ELA peaks.** Grade 2: Writing 100% in depth, Speaking and Listening 88%, Reading Foundational Skills 80%, Reading 78%. Grade 7: Reading 89%, Writing 69%, Speaking and Listening 63%, Language 62%. Coverage map ↗
2. GAPS **Kindergarten rated all its standards, and none in depth.** 60% are not taught, including 93% of Language and 78% of Reading; this is where reading and writing begin. None of its 47 power standards is rated in depth. Priority and power (Audit) ↗
3. GAPS **128 standards are not taught in their own grade.** 100 in K-5, 24 in 6-8 and 4 in 9-12. Language has 50 of them and Reading 29. Gaps and repetition ↗
4. GAPS **21 of 33 progressions break down at some step.** 4 are taught at every step K-12 (21 of 29 in high school alone). 19 standards in depth build on an earlier school's standard rated not taught, all on suggested links, not official ones, so each is worth checking first. Progressions ↗
5. BREADTH WITHOUT DEPTH **241 standards are introduced, never in depth.** 174 in K-5, 38 in 6-8 and 29 in 9-12. Language has 84 and Writing 59. Gaps and repetition ↗

ELA · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

Section 2: Patterns



Facts

Patterns
YOU ARE HERE

Moving forward

SECTION 2 OF 3

Patterns

What you are seeing. What the facts show side by side. Possibilities to discuss, not conclusions.

What it adds to our story. ELA shows what steady building across grades looks like, and that literacy also lives in Science and Social Studies.

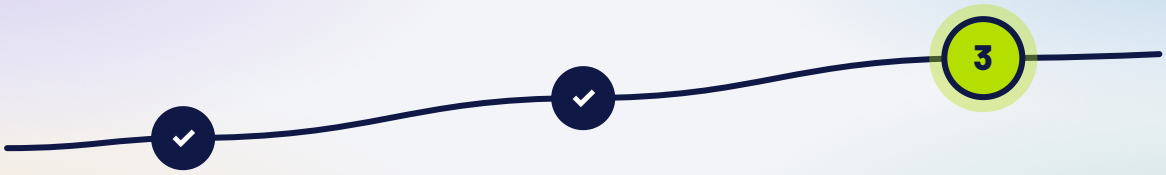
1. TRENDS ACROSS THE GRADES **The build is not a straight line.** Grade 2 (71%) is followed by Grade 3 (0%) and Grade 4 (7%), with no change of school to explain it. Grades 9 and 10 rate the same 43 standards but agree on only 18: Grade 9 introduces and Grade 10 deepens. Coverage map ↗

2. HANDOFFS **Middle school is where progressions strain.** Twelve of 29 progressions break down in Grades 6 to 8, usually where a middle school standard in depth builds on a K-5 step rated not taught. Reading and research skills (text features, evidence for claims, inquiry projects) recur. Progressions ↗

3. LANGUAGE AND LITERACY **Language never fully catches up.** It is the thinnest strand in every band (10%, 45%, 30% in depth), and 5 of the 19 hand-over gaps start from Grade 4 Language standards. The literacy audit of weekly plans found grammar and vocabulary instruction regular in only one or two elementary grades. Progressions ↗

4. LANGUAGE AND LITERACY **Foundational reading stops being in depth after Grade 2.** It is 0% in depth from Grade 3 to Grade 5, yet many of our students may still be learning to read there. Phonics and fluency may be taught below grade level, which the Grade 3 to 5 standards would not show. Coverage map ↗

5. ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS **Grade 3 may teach more than its rating shows.** Grade 3 rated 66% of its Essential Elements in depth and none of its grade-level standards. Kindergarten and Grade 4 rated few in depth at either level (Essential Elements 8% and 6%), perhaps a stricter reading or a different planning approach. Coverage map ↗



SECTION 3 OF 3

Moving forward

What you are seeing. Five questions for teams, each with its data and a first step we could take.

What it adds to our story. Sharing what works in ELA, and who takes Language to depth.

1

IMPROVING THE CURRICULUM **How is each grade's Language (grammar, conventions, vocabulary) taught: on its own, or through reading and writing, and what would take it to depth?**

(Data: Language 10%, 45%, 30% in depth by band; 50 of 128 not taught in their own grade; 84 of 241 introduced only) see Pattern 3

First step: In each band, we could decide how Language is taught: on its own, or through reading and writing.

Gaps and repetition ↗

2

WORKING ACROSS GRADE LEVELS **What happens in Grade 2 and Grade 7 ELA that we could describe, share and repeat?**

(Data: Grade 2 71% and Grade 7 70% in depth; Grade 3 0% and Grade 9 33%) see Pattern 1

First step: We might ask Grade 2 and Grade 7, 2 of our 3 ELA peaks, to share how they plan to depth with the grades around them.

Coverage map ↗

3

WORKING ACROSS GRADE LEVELS **What would a shared K-12 picture of "a strong writer at Awsaj" look like at Grades 2, 5, 8 and 12?**

(Data: Writing in depth: Grade 2 100%, Grade 5 15%, Grade 8 62%, Grade 9 15%, Grade 10 77%, Grade 12 60%) see Fact 1

First step: We might build that picture with one shared piece of work at each of Grades 2, 5, 8 and 12.

Coverage map ↗

4

KNOWING THE BANDS ABOVE AND BELOW **Which Grade 4 and Grade 5 Language and Reading standards does Grade 6 most rely on?**

(Data: 12 hand-over gaps start in Grades 4 and 5; 5 of them from Grade 4 Language standards (suggested links)) see Fact 3

First step: We could help Grades 4 and 5 learn which Reading and Language standards Grade 6 relies on most.

Progressions ↗

5

HOW WE RATE AND PLAN **How did Kindergarten and Grade 4 decide between "introduced" and "in depth", and would a shared example change any ratings?**

(Data: In depth, main standards and Essential Elements: Kindergarten 0% and 8%, Grade 4 7% and 6%, Grade 3 0% and 66%, Grade 2 71% and 73%) see Pattern 1

First step: We might rate one shared example together and see whether any ratings change.

Coverage map ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

About the data

What our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, K-12. Eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands and the four subjects. Each part opens with the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each.

ABOUT THE DATA

How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

What our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, K-12. Eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands and the four subjects. Each part opens with the picture (curricular capacity, grade by grade), then Facts, Patterns and Moving forward, five items each.

Where the numbers come from. The ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings), checked against the Vertical Alignment reports.

The three ratings.

Rating	What it means
Taught in depth	ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard
Introduced / exposed	Anything in between (for example, 3 of 5 classes)
Not taught	No class in the grade teaches it

Keep in mind.

- The ratings report teaching across a whole grade, not what students know, and they judge no one.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read it more or less strictly.
- Much literacy is also taught in Science and Social Studies, and may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of grade-level ratings. Essential Elements are counted apart.

Curricular capacity. What an average grade reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. Not a target: we cannot teach everything equally, so we choose the mix on purpose.

Categories. Each item carries a small label (for example Bright spots, Gaps, Handoffs), the same set in every part, so a team can follow one kind of observation across parts.

ABOUT THE DATA

Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

What was read

Source	How it was used	How fully it was read
Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026)	Every figure	All 2,166 rows
Organized ratings workbook	Cross-check of totals	All tabs
20 Findings decks (band and subject)	Cross-check, questions and next-step themes	All slides and speaker notes
K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages)	Cross-check	First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly
7 other Reports PDFs	Cross-check of headline figures	Scanned by search, not read page by page

How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **Not taught where it belongs (confirmed).** The grade the standard belongs to rated it not taught (for a standard shared across grades, every grade that shares it did). In Math and ELA each standard belongs to one grade, so this means that grade's team rated it not taught; it does not mean other grades should have taught it.

- **Not taught where it fits.** Each standard was placed in the grade or course where it fits best, and that grade or course rated it not taught. Other grades were not asked to rate it.
- **Introduced, never in depth (met but not owned).** Introduced in at least one grade and in depth in none.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.
- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Curricular capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

Limits to keep in view

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were placed in the grade or course where each fits best. 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also rated not taught in the grade where they fit.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.
- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

Status. This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.